

PAIN POINTS FROM USER FEEDBACK

Analysis uncovered 17 user pain points in the LMS highlighting gaps in clarity, navigation, and process transparency. These insights will directly inform targeted UX enhancement to improve overall user experience

PAIN POINTS GROUPED BASED ON PERSONAS

ADMIN

- 02 Leave approval status
- 10 Leave module system down time
- 04 Incorrect leave status
- 11 Reminder leave regularization

MANAGER

- 01 Communication on leave management
- 08 Leave application on behalf of employees
- 03 Reporting change in leave system
- 02 Leave approval status
- 04 Incorrect leave status
- 05 Cancellation of approved leaves
- 10 Leave module system down time
- 11 Reminder leave regularization
- 13 Error in advance leave

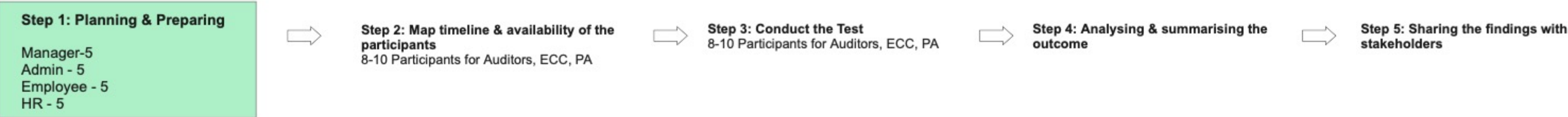
HR

- 01 Communication on leave management
- 02 Leave approval status
- 04 Incorrect leave status
- 08 Leave application on behalf of employees
- 10 Leave module system down time
- 11 Reminder leave regularization
- 13 Error in advance leave
- 16 Generate leave report

EMPLOYEE

- 01 Communication on leave management
- 06 Request leave carry forward configuration
- 07 Unable to apply leave
- 15 Paternity leave
- 03 Reporting change in leave system
- 09 Casual leave mismatch
- 10 Leave module system down time
- 05 Cancellation of approved leaves
- 12 New joiners LMS enable
- 14 Error in EL
- 17 Unable to apply comp off leave

USER STUDY



User Study task Questionnaire with 5 task per persona each with a scenario goal and tasks tailored from the 17 pain points which has been taken from user feedback. these can be used during usability testing or interviews to evaluate how participants interact with leave management systems.

Follow-Up Warm-up Questions:

1. "Can you tell me a bit about your role and your daily tasks related to payroll?"
2. "How long have you been using this payroll system?"

Persona: **Admin** - 5 Participants

"Hi [Name], thank you for taking the time to speak with us today. I'm [your Name], and I'm part of the [UX/Product/Design] team working on improving our payroll system experience. We're conducting a user study to better understand how payroll admins like you use the platform—your challenges, workflows, and what could be improved. This session is not a test of your skills; instead, we're here to learn from your experience.

Everything you share will be kept confidential and used only to improve the product. This should take about 30 to 45 minutes. Is it okay if we record the session for internal reference?"

Screening Questions:

1. Are you currently responsible for overseeing or managing leave systems in your organization?

2. Do you regularly deal with leave approval status or correcting leave records?

3. Have you previously reported or handled system downtimes?

Task 1: View leave Approval status

Scenario :
You want to quickly check which leave requests are pending for approval across departments.

Goal:
Identify all pending leave requests from employees in real time.

Task:
Show me how you'd check the current leave approval status for your team.

Task 2: Respond to a leave Module Downtime

Scenario :
The leave system was inaccessible earlier today, and you need to verify if it's back online

Goal:
Confirm system availability and log/report any outages.

Task:
Where would you go to check the system status or report a downtime issue?

Task 3: Correct and incorrect leave status

Scenario :
An employee reported their leave request is marked as 'denied' incorrect.

Goal:
Review and correct an incorrect leave record.

Task:
How would you identify and correct this employee's leave status?

Task 4: Send reminder for leave Regularisation

Scenario :
Several employees have not regularized their attendance after taking leaves.

Goal:
Send a reminder to employees to regularize pending leaves.

Task:
Show how you would remind all employees with irregular leave entries.

Task 5: Approve Multiple leaves at once

Scenario :
You need to bulk approve multiple leave requests before the day ends.

Goal:
Save time by approving leaves efficiently.

Task:
How would you bulk approve or reject multiple leave applications?

Post task (HEART)
Happiness: "On a scale of 1–5, how satisfied were you with this task?"
Engagement: "Was any part of this task slower than expected?"
Adoption: "Was the location of this feature where you expected it to be?"
Task Success: "Did you complete this task as expected?"

After All Tasks:
How confident are you using this system as an Admin? Where did you feel most friction?

Final wrap up thank u message for all:
Thank you for participating. Your insights are valuable. Do you have any final thoughts, suggestions, or pain points that stood out during this session?

Persona: **Manager** - 5 Participants

Introduction:
Thank you for joining. You'll take on the role of a Manager handling team leaves. We'll go through a few common scenarios you may encounter. Please talk through your process so we understand your thinking.

Screening Questions:

1. Do you approve leave requests for your team?

2. Have you ever had to apply leave on behalf of an employee?

3. Are you informed when leave policies change?

Task 1: Communicate Leave updates to team

Scenario :
A leave policy has changed and you need to inform your team.

Goal:
Communicate updated leave policy efficiently

Task:
How would you notify your team about the new leave rule?

Task 2: Apply leave on behalf of an Employee

Scenario :
An employee has an emergency and asked you to apply for their leave.

Goal:
Submit a leave application for someone else.

Task:
Demonstrate how you would apply for leave on their behalf.

Task 3: Report a system error

Scenario :
A team member's leave is showing incorrect balance after applying for time off.

Goal :
Report a leave discrepancy or system error.

Task :
Where would you go to flag and resolve this issue?

Task 4: Cancel an approved leave

Scenario :
An employee whose leave was previously approved now needs to cancel it.

Goal :
Cancel or edit an already approved leave request.

Task :
Show how you'd cancel or modify an approved leave on their behalf.

Task 5: Check Approval & Team Availability

Scenario :
You want to plan a project and need to check who is on leave next week.

Goal :
Get a clear view of upcoming team absences

Task :
Walk me through how you'd view your team's leave schedule.

Post task (HEART)
Happiness: "Did the system feel intuitive for this task?"
Engagement: "Did any part confuse or delay you?"
Adoption: "Was this feature familiar or new to you?"
Task Success: "Were you able to complete the task fully?"

After All Tasks:
"Which tasks took the most effort? Where do you think improvements can be made?"

Final wrap up thank u message for all:
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Persona: **HR** - 5 Participants

Introduction:
Welcome. You will perform tasks as a member of the HR team. Your tasks involve reporting, approvals, and ensuring compliance with leave policies. Please explain your actions as you go.

Screening Questions:

1. Are you involved in generating leave reports for your company?

2. Do you deal with employee complaints related to leave approvals?

3. Are you responsible for communicating policy updates?

Task 1: Communicate Leave policy changes

Scenario :
A change in the earned leave policy needs to be communicated to all employees.

Goal :
Ensure policy updates are seen and understood.

Task :
Where would you update or announce changes in leave rules?

Task 2: Handle leave approval Escalations

Scenario :
An employee has raised a complaint about delayed leave approval.

Goal :
Track the request and ensure timely approval.

Task :
Show how you would investigate and escalate this issue.

Task 3: Apply a leave on behalf of employee

Scenario :
A new employee without system access needs leave applied manually.

Goal :
Submit leave for another user.

Task :
Show how you'd apply leave for them

Task 4: Generate Department wise leave reports

Scenario :
Management requested a report of all leaves taken in the last quarter by department

Goal :
Download or generate an accurate leave report.

Task :
Demonstrate how you would generate a leave report for custom date

Task 5: Resolve advance leave errors

Scenario :
A system bug allowed employees to apply for more advance leave than allowed.

Goal :
Detect and fix or report this error.

Task :
What steps would you take to identify and correct invalid leave entries?

Post task (HEART)
Happiness: "Did this feature support your HR duties well?"
Engagement: "Did you experience any difficulty during this task?"
Adoption: "Was it easy to find and understand the tools you needed?"
Task Success: "Did everything go as expected?"

After All Tasks:
Would you trust this system for handling high-volume leave scenarios? What would you improve?

Final wrap up thank u message for all:
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Persona: **Employee** - 5 Participants

Introduction:
Thank you for being part of this session. You'll act as an employee using the system to manage your leaves. Your feedback will help us improve the user experience for everyone.

Screening Questions:

1. Do you frequently apply for leave online?

2. Have you ever had a discrepancy in your leave balance or status?

3. Do you know how to download your personal leave report?

Task 1: Track leave approval status

Scenario :
You applied for leave 2 days ago but haven't received an update

Goal :
Check your leave request status

Task :
Show how you would track your current leave request.

Task 2: Report incorrect leave balance

Scenario :
Your earned leave balance has unexpectedly reduced.

Goal :
Report or correct a leave balance issue

Task :
Where would you go to raise this issue?

Task 3: Apply for a leave

Scenario :
You need to apply for sick leave for tomorrow

Goal :
Apply for a new leave request.

Task :
Walk through how you would apply for a sick leave.

Task 4: Receive leave regularisation reminder

Scenario :
You missed clocking out during your last work-from-home day and received a regularisation reminder.

Goal :
Complete the regularisation process.

Task :
How would you respond to and regularize your attendance?

Task 5: Generate personal leave report

Scenario :
You need to submit your leave summary to your reporting manager.

Goal :
Download your personal leave history.

Task :
Show how you'd generate and download your leave report.

Post task (HEART)
Happiness: "How easy was it to complete this task?"
Engagement: "Did you have to click around a lot to figure it out?"
Adoption: "Was this a process you were familiar with?"
Task Success: "Was anything missing or broken in the flow?"

After All Tasks:
How satisfied are you using this system for your day-to-day leave management? Any improvements you'd like to see?

Final wrap up thank u message for all:
Thank you for participating. Your insights are valuable. Do you have any final thoughts, suggestions, or pain points that stood out during this session?

Note: Using tags **HEART FRAMWORK (HAPPINESS, ADOPTION, RETENTION, ENGAGEMENT, TASK SUCCESS)**, here are the tags used for each task under each persona. These tags help link each task to the most reverent UX metric's to measure during your study

H	HAPPINESS	User attitudes, satisfaction and perceived ease or delight while using the product
E	ENGAGEMENT	Level of user involvement, such as frequency, depth, and time spent.
A	ADOPTION	how quickly new users start using the product or new features
R	RETENTION	whether users continue to using the product over time (return behaviour)
T	TASK SUCESS	Efficiency, accuracy and effectiveness of users complementing key tasks

Script - Send to clients, User's

Dear [Client's Name],

I hope this message finds you well!

We are excited to inform you that the ADP team is conducting a user study aimed at enhancing our services and understanding the needs of our valued clients like you. Your insights and experiences are invaluable to us, and we would be honoured if you could participate in this study.

Purpose of the User Study:

The primary goal of this study is to gather feedback on our current offerings and identify areas for improvement. By participating, you will have the opportunity to share your thoughts and suggestions, which will directly influence the future development of our products and services.

Benefits of Participation:

- **Influence Future Developments:** Your feedback will help shape the features and functionalities that matter most to you.
- **Exclusive Insights:** Gain early access to upcoming features and enhancements based on user feedback.
- **Networking Opportunities:** Connect with other users and share experiences in a collaborative environment.

Details of the Study:

- **Date:** Any accommodable date in next 2 weeks
- **Duration:** 45 minutes(each user)
- **Scope:** We need 1 user each from the admin, manager and Employee role.
- **Format:** Virtual (Webex/MS Teams call)

We would greatly appreciate your participation in this study. If you are interested, please let us know your availability, and we will do our best to accommodate you.

Thank you for considering this opportunity to contribute to the future of ADP services. We look forward to your positive response!

02 Objectives, research questions & hypotheses

Objective: To understand...	Key questions	Hypotheses
	The questions you need to be able to answer to address that objective Specific questions that we seek to guide the overall research focus. They are broad in scope but also precise inquiries which need to be answered to address fundamental aspects of the topic. <i>Tip: ask yourself "will the answers of these questions help you achieve your initial goal? What will we do with the insights?"</i>	Hypotheses are specific, testable statements or predictions. They are derived from the research questions and are educated guesses, based on existing knowledge or observations, which describe the expected relationship between two things. Research hypotheses guide the data analysis and allow us to determine if the evidence supports our hypotheses.
[Primary objective 1]	[Research question 1]	Hypothesis 1: - What? (Outcome) - How? (Process) - Why? (Driver)
	[Research question 2]	Hypothesis 2: - What? (Outcome) - How? (Process) - Why? (Driver)
[Primary objective 2]	[Research question 3]	Hypothesis 3: - What? (Outcome) - How? (Process) - Why? (Driver)
	[Research question 4]	Hypothesis 4: - What? (Outcome) - How? (Process) - Why? (Driver)
[Primary objective 3]	[Research question 5]	Hypothesis 5: - What? (Outcome) - How? (Process) - Why? (Driver)
	[Research question 6]	Hypothesis 6: - What? (Outcome) - How? (Process) - Why? (Driver)

! An objective is an **intent** while a hypothesis is **what one believes is happening and why**.

03 Hypotheses, dream takeaways & critical information needed

Hypotheses

What we think is happening

Hypothesis 1:

Hypothesis 2:

Hypothesis 3:

Hypothesis 4:

Hypothesis 5:

Hypothesis 6:

Dream takeaway

What do we want to be able to say at the end of the research?

Critical information needed

What is the essential information needed to be collected to be able to say that?

04 Data usage & analysis

Data usage

How will you use this data? What initiatives, business decisions, processes etc. will you support with it?

Analysis

What are important comparisons you want to be able to make? Where do you expect to see differences?

Level of Detail Required

Strategic level outputs

Operational level outputs

Technical level outputs

01 Context, goal & objectives

Background / context

Why this? Why now? How did we get here?

Research goal

A broad statement that outlines the overall purpose or aim of a research study, describing the ultimate outcome or desired result.

Research objectives

A clear, concise statement of the specific goals and intended outcomes that we aim to achieve in practical, measurable and realistic terms. A well stated objective should focus on the outcomes (e.g. understand, measure, analyze, evaluate etc.)

Tip: What are the key things you need to address the problem

[Primary objective 1]

Understand the client pain points around outsourcing payroll and related services

[Primary objective 2]

Identify the key pain points the clients want to outsource (whether it is to ADP or another firm), alongside their payroll

[Primary objective 3]

Understand how they are solving for it today.

[Primary objective 4]

Understand the trigger events/reasons the clients want to outsource.

[Primary objective 5]

Validate the hypotheses of the high priority buckets and their relative importance. E.g. Which of these resonate? Why? Did we miss any? Are some less critical?

Success criteria

What does success look like?

- What decisions must be made using this research?
- What's the minimum information needed for each decision?
- What would make this research project a failure?

- Specific outcome:
- How we'll measure it:
- Target metric/ milestone:

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Intro

"Hi [Name], thank you for taking the time to speak with us today. I'm [Your Name], and I'm part of the [UX/Product/Design] team working on improving our payroll system experience. We're conducting a user study to better understand how payroll admins like you use the platform—your challenges, workflows, and what could be improved. This session is not a test of your skills; instead, we're here to learn from your experience.

Everything you share will be kept confidential and used only to improve the product. This should take about 30 to 45 minutes. Is it okay if we record the session for internal reference?"

Follow-Up Warm-up Questions:

1. "Can you tell me a bit about your role and your daily tasks related to payroll?"
2. "How long have you been using this payroll system?"

Admin

"Hi [Name], thank you for taking the time to speak with us today. I'm [Your Name], and I'm part of the [UX/Product/Design] team working on improving our payroll system experience. We're conducting a user study to better understand how payroll admins like you use the platform—your challenges, workflows, and what could be improved. This session is not a test of your skills; instead, we're here to learn from your experience.

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Follow-Up Warm-up Questions:

1. "Can you tell me a bit about your role and your daily tasks related to payroll?"
2. "How long have you been using this payroll system?"

call out this 5 flow and confirm from user whether they are into.

1. **View Leave Approval Status**
2. "Let's say you start your day and want to check the status of employee leave requests. Can you show me how you'd do that?"
3. **Respond to Leave Mobile Notifications During Downtime**
4. "Imagine you're on the move or between meetings. You get a leave request notification on your mobile. What would you typically do in that moment?"
5. **Identify Correct vs Incorrect Leave Status**
6. "Sometimes, employees may apply for leave incorrectly or under the wrong category. Can you walk me through how you identify and handle such cases?"
7. **Send Reminder for Leave Regularisation**
8. "Suppose an employee forgets to regularize their leave. How do you remind them or follow up in such scenarios?"
9. **Approve Multiple Requests at Once**
10. "Now imagine you have several leave requests pending. What's your process

Manager

"Hi [Name], thank you for joining us today. I'm [Your Name], and I'm part of the [UX/Product] team working to improve our time and payroll system for managers like yourself.

Today, we'd love to understand your daily activities related to managing your team's attendance, leaves, and time-related tasks—what's working, what's not, and where we can improve. There are no right or wrong answers; we're here to learn from your real-world experience. This session should take around [30–45 minutes]. Is it okay if we record the session for internal use?"

Follow-Up Warm-up Questions:

1. "Can you tell me a bit about your role and your daily tasks?"
2. "How long have you been using this payroll system?"

Task-Based Questions

1. Communicate Leave Updates to Team

How do you typically communicate to your team when a member applies for or gets leave approved?

Do you use the system for this, or do you rely on other tools like email or WhatsApp?

Is this process smooth, or are there any friction points?

2. Apply Leave on Behalf of an Employee

Have you ever had to apply for leave on behalf of a team member? If so, how do you do it?

Are there any specific situations when this happens?

Do you get notified when an employee asks you to apply leave for them?

3. Report a System Error

If you spot a system error—like incorrect attendance, duplicate records, or missing leave—how do you report it?

Do you have a direct way to escalate such issues?

How long does it usually take for such errors to be resolved?

4.Cancel an Approved Leave

Have you ever needed to cancel a leave that was already approved?

How do you do it, and what challenges (if any) have you faced?

Are employees notified automatically when you do this?

5.Check Approval and Team Activity Status

How often do you check team attendance, work hours, or leave status?

Do you use any dashboard or approval summary for this?

Do you find it easy to monitor your entire team's status?

Additional Manager-Centric Questions

6.Reminders & Notifications

> Do you receive alerts for pending approvals or irregularities in team attendance?

Are these notifications timely and useful?

7. Delegation & Proxy

> When you're unavailable, can someone else in your team handle approvals on your behalf?

Is there a delegation or proxy feature you use?

8.Attendance & Payroll Coordination

Do you ever need to coordinate with the payroll or HR team to ensure attendance data is correct?

What part of that process works well, and what feels manual or time-consuming?

9.Mobile vs Desktop Usage

Do you prefer handling time/leave approvals on your phone or on a computer?

What tasks do you usually do on mobile, and what do you avoid?

Closing Questions

What's the most frustrating part of handling time and attendance tasks today?

If you could change or automate one thing in the system, what would it be?

Any features you wish existed to make your job easier?

HR

"Hi [Name], thank you for taking the time to speak with us today. I'm [Your Name] from the [UX/Product] team.

We're working to improve the time and payroll product experience, and your role as HR is central to that. This session will focus on your day-to-day tasks—like managing leave, handling policy updates, resolving errors, and reporting. We're here to understand your challenges and ideas to make the system more efficient and intuitive for you.

This will take around 45 minutes. Is it okay if we record this session for internal reference only?"

Follow-Up Warm-up Questions:

1. "Can you tell me a bit about your role and your daily tasks related to payroll?"
2. "How long have you been using this payroll system?"

Key Task-Based Questions

1. Communicate Leave Policy Changes - done

When there's an update in the leave policy, how do you communicate it to employees or managers?

Do you use the system for this communication or rely on emails/manual methods?

Would you find value in a built-in policy announcement tool?

2. Handle Leave Approval Escalations - done

What kind of leave-related escalations do you typically deal with?

How do you intervene if a manager delays or denies a leave unfairly?

Do you have visibility into pending approvals across departments?

3. Apply Leave on Behalf of an Employee - done

Under what situations do you apply leave for employees?

Is this process smooth, or do you face limitations?

Are there any audit or compliance concerns with this?

Employee

Hi [Name], thank you for taking the time to speak with us today. I'm [Your Name] from the [UX/Product] team.

We're working on improving the experience of the time and payroll system for employees like you. This session is about understanding how you use the platform to manage your attendance, leaves, and other related tasks—what works well and what could be better.

This will take around 30–40 minutes. Is it okay if we record this session for internal use?"

Follow-Up Warm-up Questions:

1. "Can you tell me a bit about your role and your daily tasks related to payroll?"
2. "How long have you been using this payroll system?"

1. Track Leave Approval Status

- After you apply for leave, how do you usually check whether it has been approved?
- Do you get timely notifications or do you follow up manually?
- Is the current status clear and easy to find?

2. Report Incorrect Leave Balance

- Have you ever noticed a mistake in your leave balance? What did you do?
- Was it easy to report or raise a concern?
- How long did it take to get resolved?

3. Apply for Leave

- Can you walk us through how you apply for leave—either on desktop or mobile?
- Are all leave types clear (casual, sick, earned, etc.)?
- Any confusion or difficulties while applying?

4. Receive Leave Regularisation Reminder

- Have you ever received reminders to regularize your attendance or leave?
- How did that reminder reach you (app, email, SMS)?
- Was the process of regularizing smooth or confusing?

5. Generate Personal Leave Report

- Have you ever checked your own leave history or balance report?
- What kind of information do you usually look for (leave taken, balance, rejection reasons)?
- Would you want a downloadable version or a summary view?

Additional Employee Tasks to Explore

6. View Holiday Calendar

- How do you check official holidays or optional leaves?
- Is the calendar easy to access and understand?
- Would you like to filter by location or department?

7. Regularize Attendance

- Have you ever had to regularize attendance for missed punch or incorrect in/out times?
- How easy is it to submit that request?
- Are the reasons and options clear?

8. View Payslip or Salary Details

- How do you access your monthly payslip or salary info?
- Do you like to download your payslip or salary details (e.g., PDF)?